

ILForge — the languages

Seventeen implementations: thirteen compilers that emit **pure .NET IL**, three interpreters, and a calculator. This page is the map — what each one *is*, what it *does*, how to *run* it, and what it deliberately leaves out. Each entry links to a full reference whose tutorial examples were all compiled and run, with real output.

Everything below is a **subset** of its language, honestly bounded: the goal is a faithful, working core of each language rather than a conformance-complete implementation. Every tool accepts `-h`, or prints usage when run with no arguments.

At a glance

Language	Tool	Source	→ .exe	→ .dll (C#/VB interop)	Reference
C	<code>cc</code>	<code>.c</code>	✓	✓	lex-yacc.md
Pascal	<code>pascal</code>	<code>.pas</code>	✓	—	pascal.md
Modula-2 / Oberon-2	<code>oberon</code>	<code>.mod</code>	✓	—	oberon.md
Tiny C++	<code>tcpp</code>	<code>.cpp</code>	✓	—	tcpp.md
QBasic	<code>qbasic</code>	<code>.bas</code>	✓	—	qbasic.md
Forth	<code>forth</code>	<code>.fth</code>	✓	—	forth.md
Fortran 90	<code>fortran</code>	<code>.f90</code>	✓	✓	fortran.md
COBOL	<code>cobol</code>	<code>.cob</code>	✓	✓	cobol.md
Ada	<code>ada</code>	<code>.adb</code>	✓	✓	ada.md
Smalltalk	<code>smalltalk</code>	<code>.st</code>	✓	✓	smalltalk.md
Lua	<code>lua</code>	<code>.lua</code>	✓	✓	lua.md
AWK	<code>awk</code>	<code>.awk</code>	✓	✓	awk.md
Coil	<code>coilfe</code>	<code>.coil</code>	✓	✓	coil.md
Logo	<code>logo</code>	<code>.logo</code>	interpreted	—	logo.md
Lisp	<code>lisp</code>	<code>.lisp</code>	interpreted	—	lisp.md
Prolog	<code>prolog</code>	<code>.pl</code>	interpreted	—	prolog.md
bc	<code>bc</code>	—	REPL	—	bc.md

Common shape for the compilers:

```
<tool> <source> [-o <output>]           # produce output.exe (+ output.dll)
<tool> <source> -o lib.dll --dll         # produce a library for C#/VB.NET (where supported)
```

cc additionally takes `-I <dir>` (include search), `-L <dir>` / `-l <name>` (library search and staging), `--icon <file>` / `--noicon`, and honours `INCLUDE` and `LIB` from the environment — the ILForge Developer Command Prompt sets those, as a Visual Studio prompt does.

The compilers

C — **cc**

The foundation: a C89-plus compiler that lowers C to IL directly. Everything else in ILForge is built with it, including `lex`, `yacc`, and the other compilers.

- **Implemented:** the C89 core — `int` / `char` / `double` / `long`, pointers, arrays, `struct` / `union`, `typedef`, `enum`, functions, all the operators, `static` locals, the full statement set, a real preprocessor (`#define` object- and function-like, `#include`, `#ifdef` / `#if` / `#elif` / `#else`, line continuations), and a large built-in libc (`printf` family, `str*`, `mem*`, `malloc` / `free`, `fopen` / `fgets` / `fputs`, `atoi` / `atof` / `strtod`, `math`).
- **Memory model:** one flat byte arena; a C pointer is an `int` offset into it. That is what makes arbitrary C pointer arithmetic expressible in verifiable IL.
- **Interop:** `--dll` exposes each function as a `public static` method on `CProgram`, so C# calls it with ordinary .NET signatures.
- **Not implemented:** `float` as a distinct type (all floating point is `double`), bitfields, `goto` into blocks, variadic *user* functions (libc *varargs* work), `setjmp` / `longjmp`, and the wider C99/C11 additions.

Pascal — **pascal**

Turbo-Pascal-flavoured Pascal. See [pascal.md](#) for the verified feature list, tutorial and boundaries.

Modula-2 / Oberon-2 — **oberon**

Wirth's successors to Pascal, sharing one front end. See [oberon.md](#).

Tiny C++ — **tcpp**

C with classes, and the polymorphism that follows from them.

- **Implemented:** C scalars, pointers, arrays, `struct`, and **classes** — a class is a struct with a hidden vtable pointer at offset 0, so a derived pointer is layout-compatible with its base. Single inheritance, `virtual` methods and real dynamic dispatch, constructors, `new` / `delete`, member functions, C strings.
- **Not implemented:** templates, the STL, namespaces, operator overloading, multiple inheritance, exceptions, destructors at scope exit (RAII), `auto` / range-`for`, `std::string`. `#include` is

unnecessary (libc is built in) and not processed.

QBasic — qbasic

The Microsoft BASIC most people met first, including its graphics.

- **Implemented:** suffix-typed variables (`%` integer, `&` long, `!` single, `#` double, `$` string; unsuffixed numerics are double), arrays with constant bounds, `SUB` and `FUNCTION` with **by-reference** parameters, `IF / ELSEIF`, `FOR / NEXT` with `STEP`, `WHILE / WEND`, `DO / LOOP`, `SELECT CASE`, `GOTO` /labels, `PRINT / INPUT`, string functions, and a graphics word set (`SCREEN`, `PSET`, `LINE`, `CIRCLE`, `PAYNT`) that renders in the `ilgfx` window — run those with `gfx <name>` from the shell. Emits `#line` info, so compiled BASIC is debuggable at source level.
- **Not implemented:** `GOSUB / RETURN`, `$INCLUDE`, `TYPE...END TYPE` records, `READ / DATA`, fixed-length strings, `PRINT USING`, distinct single vs double precision, event traps.

Forth — forth

A stack language on a .NET stack: the data stack is a `Stack<object>`, so cells hold `int`, `double`, or `string` and the operators are polymorphic by runtime type.

- **Implemented:** the core word set (arithmetic, comparison, stack shuffling, `.` / `."`), colon definitions `: name ... ;` compiled to real methods, `IF / ELSE / THEN`, `DO / LOOP`, `BEGIN / UNTIL / WHILE / REPEAT`, `VARIABLE / CONSTANT`, `@ / !`, and string literals `S" ..."`.
- **Not implemented:** cell-array words (`CREATE / ALLOT / CELLS`), return-stack words (`>R / R>`), `DOES>` /defining words, `IMMEDIATE` /compile-time metaprogramming, `ABORT` /exceptions, floating-point formatting words. `VARIABLE` gives one cell.

Fortran 90 — fortran

Free-form Fortran with the numerics that make it Fortran.

- **Implemented:** `PROGRAM / SUBROUTINE / FUNCTION` (subroutine arguments **by reference**, function arguments by value), `INTEGER / REAL / LOGICAL / CHARACTER`, arrays, `IF / THEN / ELSE`, `DO` loops, `DO WHILE`, arithmetic and the intrinsic functions, `PRINT / WRITE`.
- **Interop:** each procedure becomes `CProgram.f_<name>`.
- **Full detail:** [fortran.md](#).

COBOL — cobol

The most complete of the set, and the one that behaves most like the original.

- **Implemented:** all four divisions; `PICTURE` parsing with edited fields; group and record hierarchies with `OCCURS` tables, `VALUE`, 88-level condition names, and `OF / IN` qualification; `MOVE` (including group moves and `CORRESPONDING`), arithmetic verbs with `ROUNDED`, `PERFORM` (`TIMES / UNTIL / VARYING / THRU`), `IF / ELSE`, class and sign conditions, `STRING / UNSTRING / INSPECT`, `SET`, `INITIALIZE`, reference modification, intrinsic `FUNCTION` s, subprograms with `LINKAGE SECTION` + `CALL / GOBACK`, and **line-sequential file I/O** (`SELECT / ASSIGN`, `FD`, `OPEN / CLOSE / READ / WRITE` with `FILE STATUS`).

- **Not implemented:** `SEARCH`, `EVALUATE TRUE`, inline `AT END` on `READ`, `REDEFINES`, fixed-format source, indexed/relative files, `REWRITE`, `COPY`.

Ada — `ada`

Strong typing, and the parameter modes that Ada is known for.

- **Implemented:** `Integer` / `Float` / `Boolean` / `Character` / `String`, enumerations, 1-based arrays, functions and procedures with `in` (by value) and `out` / `in out` (**by reference**) parameters, `if` / `elsif` / `else`, `case` / `when` / `others`, `loop` / `while` / `for` (including `reverse`) with `exit when`, `'Image`, `&` concatenation, `Ada.Text_IO`. Case-insensitive, as Ada is.
- **Not implemented:** packages with separate spec/body, generics, tasking, exceptions, `record` types, access types, `declare` blocks, 2-D arrays and array attributes.

Smalltalk — `smalltalk`

Everything is an object; every operation is a message send, dispatched at run time.

- **Implemented:** boxed objects for all values, the classic **unary > binary > keyword** precedence (binary strictly left-to-right — `3 + 4 * 2` is 14), class definitions with instance variables and methods, `^` return, `self`, `Class new`, and the control-flow messages (`ifTrue:ifFalse:`, `whileTrue:`, `to:do:`, `timesRepeat:`) which are recognised and compiled inline.
- **Interop:** at the object-runtime level — C# creates instances and sends messages with selector strings.
- **Not implemented:** collection classes and their `do:` / `collect:` protocol, blocks as first-class values (they work only as inlined control-flow arguments), class-side methods, inheritance beyond one level, cascades, metaclasses.

Lua — `lua`

Dynamically typed, built on the table.

- **Implemented:** nil/boolean/number/string/table/function; **tables** doing array and hash duty together (1-based, `#`, `t.k` sugar); first-class functions, lambda-lifted to real methods so they can be stored in tables and passed around; `:` method sugar with `self`; multiple assignment (`a, b = b, a`); numeric and generic (`pairs` / `ipairs`) `for`, `while`, `repeat` / `until`, `if` / `elseif`; `print` / `type` / `tostring` / `tonumber`.
- **Not implemented:** closures that capture an enclosing function's locals (named functions are global, so recursion works), multiple return values, metatables, varargs, `goto`, the integer/float distinction (all numbers are doubles).

AWK — `awk`

Pattern-action text processing over standard input.

- **Implemented:** `BEGIN` / `END` and `pattern { action }` rules, fields (`$0` / `$1` / `NF` / `NR`) with `FS` / `OFS` / `ORS`, dynamic string-or-number values, associative arrays with `for (k in a)` and `delete`, regex patterns and `~` / `!~`, **string concatenation by juxtaposition**, all the operators,

`if / while / do / for` (both forms), `next / exit`, user functions, and the built-ins `length`, `substr`, `index`, `split`, `sprintf`, `toupper`, `tolower`, plus the math set.

- **Not implemented:** `sub / gsub / match`, `getline`, multiple input files (`FNR`, `FILENAME`), output redirection, arrays as function arguments, regex alternation/grouping.

Coil — `coilfe`

A deliberately tiny curly-brace language that sits roughly 1:1 with IL — the clearest window onto what the CLR actually executes. Uniquely, its back end is a C# `Reflection.Emit` assembler (`coilasm`) rather than `cc`.

- **Implemented:** five CLR primitive types, functions, `if / else`, `while`, locals/params, arithmetic and comparison, `print / println`.
- **Not implemented:** arrays/collections, `for / do`, input, user-defined types, global variables, calls to arbitrary .NET methods, wider numeric types, exceptions.

The interpreters

Logo — `logo`

Turtle graphics that render to a file: `logo prog.logo -png out.png` (also `-svg` and animated `-gif`); no arguments gives a REPL.

- **Implemented:** numbers, words (`"hello`), lists (`[a b c]`), also command blocks), the turtle words (`FORWARD / BACK / RIGHT / LEFT / PENUP / PENDOWN / SETPENCOLOR`), `REPEAT` with `:repcount`, `IF / IFELSE`, `TO ... END` procedures with inputs and recursion, arithmetic, `PRINT`.
- **Not implemented:** arrays, full list processing (`FIRST / BUTFIRST / FPUT`), property lists, `RUN`, dynamic `THING`, most of a full Logo library.

Lisp — `lisp`

A cons-cell Lisp with closures, and a metacircular evaluator written in itself.

- **Implemented:** numbers, interned symbols, strings, `()`, cons pairs, lambda closures; `define / lambda / if / cond / let / begin / quote / set!`, the list and arithmetic primitives, `apply`, `eval`, and a prelude written in Lisp.
- **Not implemented:** macros, tail-call optimization (deep non-tail recursion can overflow), vectors/hash tables, string manipulation beyond literals, `call/cc`, exceptions, the full numeric tower.

Prolog — `prolog`

Real unification with a binding trail, SLD resolution, backtracking, and the cut.

- **Implemented:** atoms, numbers, variables, compound terms, lists (`[a, b | T]`); facts and rules, conjunction, the cut `!`, arithmetic via `is`, comparison, if-then-else (`C → T ; E`), and query output.

- **Not implemented:** `assert` / `retract` , `findall` / `bagof` / `setof` , `op/3` , a real string type, DCGs, exceptions, full I/O.

bc — bc

A scientific calculator: `bc "2+3*4"` , or a REPL with no arguments.

- **Implemented:** one type (`double`), full operator precedence, parentheses, named variables, `pi` and `e` , and the scientific function set.
- **Not implemented:** `define` functions, statements (`if` / `while` / `for`), arrays, arbitrary precision (`scale`), strings.

Building your own

The same `lex` + `yacc` + `cc` pipeline that produced every compiler above is documented in [lex-yacc.md](#), with two worked examples — a calculator and a small shell — under `examples/lexyacc/` .